

LEARNORA

THE PRACTICAL DIGITAL SKILLS SERIES

A clear path from search

SEO for Beginners

Find useful topics. Build pages people want.
Measure what search actually brings.

WORKBOOK + 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

For Indian creators, students, freelancers and small businesses

2026 EDITION

LEARN TODAY. EARN TOMORROW.

A WORKING BOOK, NOT A GLOSSARY

How to use this guide

SEO means making a website easier for search engines to discover and understand, and more useful for people who search. Use this guide on one real site or one sample project. Each exercise creates an asset you can reuse.

If you have...	Your first path
A service business	Start with your service and location pages; use the Surat example.
A content site or portfolio	Start with one audience problem and one helpful article.
An online store	Start with a category and one product family; describe real selection details.

YOUR WORKING FILE

Create a simple sheet with tabs named Pages, Topic Ideas, Publishing, and Monthly Review. Keep one URL per row.

WHAT YOU WILL PRODUCE

- A focused topic map and one-page content brief.
- An improved page with useful copy, clear title, images and internal links.
- A verified Search Console property and a recurring review routine.

REALITY CHECK

SEO has no promised rank, traffic, lead count or timeline. Search engines decide whether and how a page appears; competition, site history, relevance and changing results all matter. Treat the first month as setup and learning.

Your route through SEO

Module	Pages
01 Understand search	4-5
02 Choose topics	6-8
03 Build a good page	9-12
04 Make the site accessible	13-14
05 Local visibility and reputation	15-16
06 Measure and decide	17-18
07 The 30-day plan	19-20
08 Templates, fixes and sources	21-24

A USEFUL ORDER

Work in the order shown. Do the exercises with an actual page open. A polished keyword list cannot rescue a page that does not answer the visitor's question.

KEY USED THROUGHOUT

- Official guidance: statements tied to Google documentation are listed in Sources & Further Reading.
- Recommendation: a practical workflow proposed by Learnora, not a search engine rule.
- Illustrative example: fictional copy or sample data designed to demonstrate a method.

What SEO can influence

A simplified journey is discover → crawl → index → show → click → act. A search engine must find the page and process it before it can consider showing it. Being indexed is eligibility, not a promise of visibility.

Stage	Your useful check
Discover	Can a visitor reach the page through links from your site?
Crawl	Does the URL load without a login, server error or accidental block?
Index	Does URL Inspection show the page indexed, or explain why not?
Show	Does the page answer a query better than a thin summary?
Click	Does its title clearly promise the content actually delivered?
Act	Is the next step clear: call, enquire, read, compare or buy?

SEARCH INTENT COMES FIRST

The same word can mean different tasks. “Solar panel price Surat” may call for pricing context and an estimate; “how solar panels work” calls for an explanation. Build for the task behind the search.

Organic search results are different from ads. SEO work can improve a page and its eligibility, but no one can pay Google to guarantee an organic ranking.

The four levers you control

1

Audience fit

Write for a specific person and decision. What must they know before taking the next step?

2

Useful content

Answer the question directly; add original details such as process, constraints, photos, comparisons or examples.

3

Accessible website

Make important pages reachable through normal links, readable on mobile, and technically available to crawlers.

4

Feedback loop

Use Search Console to see queries, pages, clicks, impressions and indexing status; revise based on evidence.

AVOID A COMMON SHORTCUT

There is no magic word count, keyword density or fixed character count for titles. Use natural language and check whether the page solves the intended task.

MINI EXERCISE: DEFINE ONE PAGE

Prompt	Your answer
Page I can improve this week	_____
Who is it for?	_____
What decision will it help?	_____
What proof can I add?	_____

A keyword is a clue, not a command

Collect phrases customers would actually use. Start with your service or product, the problem, alternatives, location and questions asked before purchase. Use Google Search suggestions and your own customer messages as discovery inputs, then inspect actual results.

Search phrase (illustrative)	Likely task	Better page type
"solar installation Surat"	Find a local provider	Service page
"rooftop solar cost factors"	Understand a decision	Explainer / FAQ
"solar installer vs electrician"	Compare options	Comparison guide
"solar maintenance checklist"	Complete a task	Practical guide

INDIA-FIRST TIP

Customers may search in English, Hindi, Gujarati or a mixed phrase. Use the language that truly matches your service and support. Do not mechanically duplicate city pages with only the city name changed.

MAKE A FIRST TOPIC LIST

Write 12 phrases: 4 service/product phrases, 4 problem questions and 4 comparison or local phrases. Group phrases that lead to the same answer; each group usually needs one strong page, not one page per variation.

A simple topic scoring sheet

Before producing a page, decide if it belongs on your site. The score below is a Learnora prioritisation tool, not a ranking factor. Give each item 0, 1 or 2 points.

Criterion	0	1	2
Audience match	Unrelated	Adjacent	Core buyer/reader
Answer ability	No expertise	Some evidence	Strong first-hand detail
Business value	No next step	Indirect	Clear next step
Gap in current site	Already answered	Needs refresh	No useful page

DECISION RULE

Prioritise topics with stronger audience match and answer ability. A high sum alone does not justify a page if the topic falls outside your real expertise. This worksheet helps allocate effort; it predicts no traffic.

COPY INTO YOUR TOPIC IDEAS TAB

Topic / query group	Audience	Page type	Score	Proof to add
_____	_____	_____	___	_____
_____	_____	_____	___	_____
_____	_____	_____	___	_____

Read the search results before you write

Search the phrase yourself and inspect several results. The page types shown can signal the task people expect to complete. Results vary by location and time, so record what you see rather than assuming your preferred format will fit.

1**Classify the result**

Are the prominent results service pages, lists, guides, products, maps or videos?

2**Note missing answers**

What question remains unclear? Can you add a genuine explanation, photo, demonstration or decision aid?

3**Choose one page promise**

Write: "This page helps [person] decide/do [task] by showing [specific value]."

4**Set an honest next step**

After learning, can the visitor enquire, compare options, download a checklist or visit a related page?

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Query group: "industrial solar planning Surat." Page promise: "Help a factory manager prepare the site, bill and load details needed before requesting a system assessment." Proof: actual process, team details and project photos only if the business owns them.

The one-page content brief

Field	Fill before drafting
Primary task	What exactly is the reader trying to do?
Audience / location	Who needs the answer? Include city only when relevant.
Page promise	One sentence describing the outcome of reading.
Original evidence	Your process, data, photos, experience or verified sources.
Essential sections	Answer; steps; costs/constraints if known; FAQ; next step.
Internal links	Two or three genuinely related pages.
Conversion	One clear action suitable for the reader's stage.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

For a Surat sewing class: explain what is taught, who the course suits, location or service area, batch schedule, how admission works, and how to contact the class. Only publish current details confirmed by the business.

Keep notes about what you can verify. If you do not know a price, quote a transparent pricing process instead of inventing a number.

Page anatomy: from result to response

Element	Practical instruction
Title element	Name the actual page and distinguishing value. Google may choose a different title link.
Meta description	Summarise the page clearly; Google may generate another snippet.
Main heading (H1)	Tell visitors what this page covers in plain language.
Opening answer	Give a useful answer early, then expand with evidence.
Subheadings	Organise steps, comparisons, conditions and FAQs.
Images	Use relevant images, sensible filenames and descriptive alt text.
Internal links	Link where another page answers the natural next question.
Call to action	State the next step without interrupting the explanation.

COPY PATTERN

Title: [Service or topic] in [relevant location] | [specific difference]

Opening: "This page explains [decision], including [key detail] and [next step]." Use only details the page really contains.

A before-and-after rewrite

Illustrative example: A fictional sewing class page. These are sample words for a writing exercise, not a real business claim.

WEAK OPENING

“Best sewing course in Surat. We offer top quality training at affordable rates. Contact us now for more information.”

IMPROVED OPENING

“Explore the in-person sewing course in Surat: see what you will learn, how the lessons are structured, available batch timings and how to enquire about admission. Bring your questions about equipment and prior experience to your first conversation.”

WHY THE REWRITE HELPS

- It names the actual learning task and the admission decision.
- It gives the reader a useful route through the page.
- It removes unverified “best” and “affordable” claims.

YOUR TURN

Rewrite one vague sentence from your own site. Replace adjectives with details a visitor can check: scope, process, eligibility, delivery area, materials or constraints.

A publish-ready content checklist

- ☐ The page answers its primary question near the top.
- ☐ The title and H1 accurately describe the page; headings follow a logical order.
- ☐ Claims, prices, availability and contact details are checked.
- ☐ At least one useful detail comes from direct experience or reliable evidence.
- ☐ Links take readers to related, working pages with descriptive anchor text.
- ☐ Images have a purpose and descriptive alt text where appropriate.
- ☐ On a phone, text is readable and the enquiry path works.
- ☐ The page has one preferred URL and is not an almost identical city/keyword variant.

WHAT TO SKIP

Do not repeat a phrase unnaturally, add irrelevant FAQs, bury the answer, or publish many near-identical pages. Helpful content is the target; a checklist is only a final safety check.

Technical SEO: the beginner pass

Start with real failures, not a long audit. A usable page should load, be accessible through links, and show its important content to a visitor and a search engine.

1**Open the page in a private window**

Confirm it loads without sign-in and the main answer appears on mobile.

2**Check internal paths**

Reach the page from the homepage or a sensible category; fix broken links.

3**Inspect the URL**

In Search Console, paste the exact URL and read its index status. If changed, use the live test and request indexing when appropriate.

4**Review duplicates**

If the same content appears at several URLs, choose a preferred version; use redirects or canonical hints where suitable.

5**Check speed experience**

Use PageSpeed Insights and Core Web Vitals as diagnostics; solve clear usability issues before chasing a perfect score.

CAUTION

A sitemap helps discovery and reporting but does not guarantee indexing. A robots.txt block and a noindex instruction are different controls; do not change either without understanding the effect.

Set up Search Console

1

Add your property

Go to Google Search Console and choose a Domain or URL-prefix property. Follow the verification instructions for your site access.

2

Check important URLs

Use URL Inspection on the homepage and a key service/article page. Record the status and any reason a URL is excluded.

3

Find or submit a sitemap

Many site platforms generate one. Check the Sitemaps report if you use a sitemap; a small well-linked site may not need manual submission.

4

Open Performance

Choose Search results; review queries, pages, countries, clicks and impressions. Set a date range and save a baseline.

FIRST BASELINE WORKSHEET

Date: _____ Property: _____ Important URL: _____
Index status: _____ Clicks: _____ Impressions: _____
One next action: _____

Search Console reports Google Search performance. If you also use an analytics product, its session counts can differ because the systems measure different things.

Local SEO for an Indian service business

If customers visit your location or you serve them in a defined area, a Google Business Profile can help them find accurate business details. Google describes local ranking in terms of relevance, distance and prominence; it does not promise a rank for completing a profile.

Priority	Action
Business details	Use the real business name, category, hours, phone, service details and accurate service area.
Website landing page	Describe the actual service and where it is available; make enquiry simple.
Photos and reviews	Use real photos and follow platform rules for requesting and responding to reviews.
Consistency	Check that your website and profile present current contact details.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A Surat repair service should explain the repair types it actually handles, how booking works, any relevant service area and what a customer should prepare. A page for another city is useful only if the business truly serves it with distinct information.

Links and mentions without shortcuts

Links can help visitors and crawlers find useful pages. Start inside your own site: link from a broad service page to a detailed guide, and from a guide to the relevant enquiry page. Use anchor text that describes the destination.

Good outreach opportunity	Reason to reach out
A relevant partner or supplier	A genuine resource, specification or collaboration they may cite.
An association or event you joined	A factual member or event page linking to your real profile.
A useful original resource	A checklist, study or tool others may independently share.

AVOID

Do not buy link packages, exchange links at scale or publish guest posts solely to manipulate rankings. Google treats link spam and scaled content abuse as policy violations.

INTERNAL LINK MAP EXERCISE

Choose three pages: broad page → detailed answer → suitable next step. Record the exact anchor text and check that every link works.

Read the numbers in context

Metric	Meaning	Better question
Impressions	How often a result was shown under Google's reporting rules	Which page/query is gaining exposure?
Clicks	Visits initiated from the Google result	Which useful pages attract searchers?
CTR	Clicks divided by impressions	Is the result matching the query?
Average position	Average ranking position across shown results	Is a change broad or query-specific?

DO NOT DIAGNOSE FROM ONE NUMBER

CTR and average position vary by query, device and result layout. Compare the same page and query group over a sensible period. Do not rewrite a useful page because of a single day's movement.

A MONTHLY REVIEW ROUTINE

1

Compare equivalent periods

Use Search Console filters consistently and note major site changes.

2

Find one page opportunity

Look for relevant queries where your page is seen but does not answer well enough.

3

Make one meaningful change

Add missing detail, clarify a title, improve a broken path or strengthen an internal link.

4

Record what changed

Log date, URL, hypothesis and follow-up date before starting the next change.

Turn observations into actions

You observe...	Investigate first	Possible action
Page not indexed	URL Inspection reason; access; duplicate/canonical	Fix the specific reason, then request recrawl if relevant.
Impressions, few clicks	Query intent; title; competing result type	Clarify title and opening; ensure page really answers.
Clicks, few enquiries	Page clarity; trust; form or call path	Test the CTA and explain next step.
Many similar pages	Duplicate purpose and overlapping queries	Consolidate or differentiate with real value.

EXAMPLE REVIEW NOTE

Illustrative example: “The service page appears for a maintenance query, but only lists installation services. Add a concise maintenance section if the business offers it; otherwise link to an appropriate existing page.” No traffic outcome is assumed.

If a page answers its task well and the index status is healthy, patience can be a valid decision. Use evidence, not a fixed promise of how long SEO “should” take.

Days 1-15: build the foundation

Day	Deliverable
1	Pick one real site, one audience and one measurable visitor action.
2	List important pages and confirm their current URLs.
3	Create or verify a Search Console property.
4	Inspect the homepage and one key page; note index status.
5	Check mobile readability, loading and working contact paths.
6	Collect customer questions and phrases from your own conversations.
7	Draft 12 search phrases across service, problem and comparison.
8	Group phrases by the task behind them.
9	Inspect search results for the three strongest groups.
10	Score topics for audience fit, answer ability and value.
11	Choose one page to improve and write its page promise.
12	Gather verified facts, photos, process details or sources.
13	Draft a clear outline and direct opening answer.
14	Write the full page and a suitable next step.
15	Edit for accuracy, useful detail and plain language.

CHECKPOINT

By day 15 you should have a verified property, a topic map and one edited draft. A lack of search traffic at this stage is not a failure signal.

Days 16–30: publish and learn

Day	Deliverable
16	Write an accurate title element, description and H1.
17	Add useful images and appropriate alt text.
18	Add two relevant internal links and check destinations.
19	Check the page on a phone and in a private browser window.
20	Publish or update the page; log URL and date.
21	Inspect the published URL and test live access.
22	Check sitemap status if your platform provides one.
23	Improve one related page or navigation path.
24	If local, confirm Business Profile details and website link.
25	Check broken links, outdated claims and enquiry path.
26	Record Search Console baseline for the page.
27	Make a brief for the next distinct audience question.
28	Draft the second page or add missing evidence to an existing one.
29	Review the log: actions complete and unresolved blockers.
30	Schedule a monthly review; choose one evidence-led next action.

CHECKPOINT

The goal is a repeatable publishing and review process. Indexing, rankings and leads are outside the plan's control.

Copy-paste working templates

CONTENT BRIEF

COPY INTO YOUR NOTES

Page URL: _____ Audience: _____ Search task: _____
One-sentence promise: _____ Evidence I can show: _____
Main answer: _____ Supporting questions: _____
Related internal pages: _____ Appropriate next step: _____

SEARCH-RESULT REVIEW

COPY INTO YOUR NOTES

Query group: _____ Date / location: _____
Common result types: _____ Repeated questions: _____
What is missing: _____ My genuine added value: _____
Chosen page type: _____ Publish / revise / skip: _____

MONTHLY CHANGE LOG

COPY INTO YOUR NOTES

Date: _____ URL: _____ Observation: _____
Evidence: _____ Hypothesis: _____ Change made: _____
Review date: _____ What happened: _____ Next action: _____

Write one hypothesis per change when possible. A useful log preserves your reasoning even when a result is inconclusive.

Common mistakes and quick fixes

Mistake	What to do instead
A page for every tiny phrase	Group equivalent searches and publish one useful answer.
A near-identical page per city	Use genuine service-area detail; avoid doorway-style duplication.
Publishing unverified AI text	Check claims, add first-hand value and correct sources.
Buying “guaranteed ranking”	Ask for specific work and reporting; no one controls organic rank.
Treating a sitemap as a fix	Inspect the URL and resolve the actual access or quality issue.
Chasing scores over visitors	Fix mobile usability, broken actions and relevant content first.
Only measuring rank	Track index health, query fit, clicks and meaningful actions.

DECISION GUIDE

If you have just one hour, choose the highest impact verified problem: a broken conversion path, a blocked important URL, an inaccurate page, or an important question your page fails to answer.

Sources & further reading

Official Google guidance consulted for this 2026 edition. Platform interfaces and policies can change; use these live pages to confirm current details before making sitewide changes.

SEO Starter Guide

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide>

Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/creating-helpful-content>

Search Essentials and spam policies

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials>

Spam policies

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials/spam-policies>

Search Console: getting started

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/monitor-debug/search-console-start>

Performance report

<https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/7576553>

Page indexing report

<https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/7440203>

Sitemaps report

<https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/7451001>

Title links and snippets

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/title-link>

Local ranking guidance

<https://support.google.com/business/answer/7091>

Core Web Vitals

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/core-web-vitals>

EDITORIAL NOTE

The page examples and worksheets are original illustrative teaching material. No quoted performance results, case studies or guaranteed outcomes are presented.

Keep the system simple

SEO becomes manageable when each page has a clear purpose, credible information, a usable path and a review habit. You can return to the worksheets whenever a new service, product or audience question appears.

1**Choose the next question**

Select a real customer need that your site can answer well.

2**Improve the page**

Add specific evidence, clear structure and a useful next step.

3**Check access**

Confirm the URL loads, is linked and has no unintended indexing issue.

4**Review and learn**

Record what Search Console shows; make the next change for a reason.

YOUR NEXT 60 MINUTES

Open your strongest page, write the visitor's question at the top of a working note, inspect the page on mobile, add one missing answer, and record the change date.

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Learn Today. Earn Tomorrow.

END OF GUIDE